My PhD Journey

Asta Halkjær From

Comwell Holte, 27 September 2021

Me

25. Trans woman. Live in Birkerød.

I like

- Logic (especially Modal)
- Proof Assistants (especially Isabelle)
- Type Theory (especially Dependent)

https://people.compute.dtu.dk/ahfrom/

Timeline I

29 January 2020	Defend MSc thesis
03 February 2020	Start PhD
04 February 2020	TA 02102 first time
07 February 2020	TA 02256 first time
09 February 2020	Move to Ballerup
11 March 2020	Denmark shuts down (covid)
30 June 2020	Isabelle Workshop talk
1 July 2020	IJCAR talk (short paper)

Timeline II

13 July 2020	Virtual ESSLLI student session (summer school cancelled)
26 July 2020	CICM doctoral session talk
29 July 2020	Marktoberdorf summer school cancelled
19 August 2020	Start HRT
26 August 2020	AiML talk (short paper)
03 September 2020	TA 02287 first time
03 September 2020	Belief revision special course first time
19 October 2020	42750 Sustainability course first time

Timeline III

14 January 2021	World Logic Day talk (informal)
01 February 2021	Topology, Logic, Learning course first time (virtually UvA)
03 February 2021	Logic of Action special course (no ECTS)
01 April 2021	Move to Valby
01 May 2021	Start of Virtual Research stay in Amsterdam
04 May 2021	LAMAS & SR worshop talk (short paper)
07 June 2021	First solo paper published (TYPES 2020)
13 July 2021	Second solo paper accepted (WoLLIC 2021)

Timeline IV

26 July 2021	Virtual ESSLLI starts (I co-chair the student session)
28 July 2021	CICM talk
31 July 2021	Grandmother dies
08 August 2021	Move to Birkerød
9 September 2021	Modal Logic seminar course starts (no ECTS)
27 September 2021	“My PhD Journey” talk

Missing (lots): supervision, joint publications, meetings, half-year reports etc.

Department Work

Accumulated department work	
Activity	*Hours*
TA 02102	65
TA 02256	85
Special Course Supervisor Type Theory	10
Special Course Supervisor Algebraic Topology	15
Special Course Supervisor Visualization of Proofs	10
TA 02287	50
Special Course Supervisor Simple Prover	10
Special Course Supervisor Algebraic Topology	15
Special Course Supervisor Advanced Topics in Types and Programming Languages	15
Special Course Supervisor Sequent Calculus Verifier	10
Special Course Supervisor A Case Study in Computer-Assisted Meta-Reasoning	10
Special Course Supervisor Advanced Automated Reasoning	10
BSc Thesis Supervisor Prover Programming	20
BSc Thesis Supervisor A Proof Tool for First-Order Logic	20
MSc Thesis Supervisor Formalization of Logical Systems in Isabelle (student on Honours Programme)	50

Writing

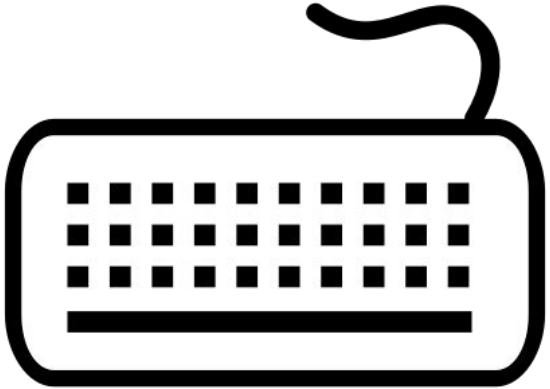
Big part of the job!

A lot more fun when you know what you're doing…

Pay attention to the obligatory courses!!!

Ask your supervisor or other collaborators for advice

Warning: bad writing will start to annoy you



Speaking

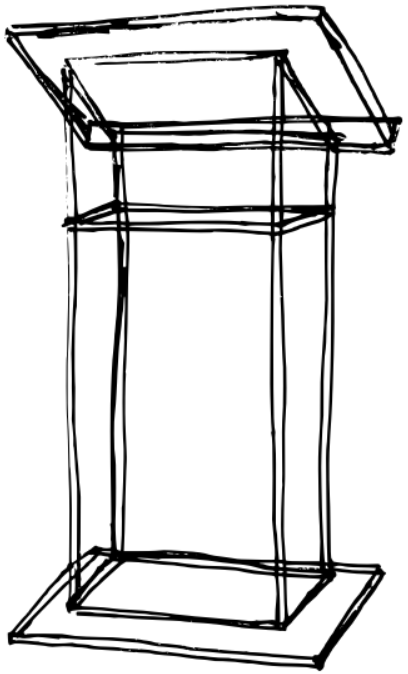
Big part of the job!

A lot more fun when you know what you're doing…

My advice: rehearse!

Knowing what you're going to say leaves energy for jokes

Also: pay attention to the communications course



Conferences

How do you get to practice writing and speaking?

- Summer school student sessions
- Conferences with doctoral sessions
- Workshops
- Conferences (short papers / long papers)
- Journals

Ask your supervisor for places to send your work at various stages

Thinking

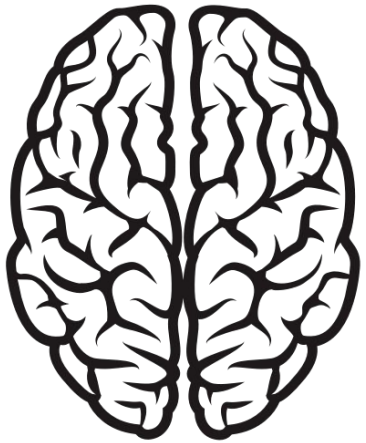
I think best at home. Some think best at the office. Find your style

I think best after lunch. Some think best in the morning/evening. Find your style.

I would rather work few but intense hours.
Some would rather work many but on-and-off hours.
Find your style.

I only work weekends sometimes. You?

Don’t schedule meetings in your best thinking time (if you can).
Don’t look at email in your best thinking time (if you can).



Half-Year Plans

Write down what you do!

You need to fill it in every half year.

Write down what you do!

My supervisor and I keep a synchronized Overleaf.

Write down what you do! (putting **everything** in your calendar helps too)

Questions?